Medical Necessity Review Criteria

Original Effective Date: 1/10/2023
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Review Date: 5/27/2025
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All GEHA Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Scope:

Any authorization request, which includes, but is not limited to, chemotherapy, immunotherapy, supportive agents, CAR-T, and any newly approved therapeutic treatments used in oncology.

Universal Approval Criteria:

- OncoHealth follows a hierarchical process for reviewing utilization requests. The hierarchy varies depending upon the line of business. Commercial lines of business follow medical policy, however, when no medical policy exists, OH will follow the hierarchy to determine medical necessity. Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:
    - Coverage determination may be directed, where applicable, by the Centers of Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 or the Medicare Prescription Drug Benefit Manual, Chapter 6. National Coverage Determinations (NCD) or Local Coverage Determinations (LCD) may exist for which compliance is required. Coverage determinations may also be directed by state-specific Medicaid drug utilization requirements and/or health plan specific drug coverage policies; **OR**
    - United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling (on-label use); **OR**
    - Drugs or regimens may be used off-label (without FDA support) and considered medically necessary if supported by any of the following compendia below and not listed as unsupported, not indicated, or not recommended within any compendia below.
        - National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2a level of evidence;
            - Category 2B recommendations will be considered medically necessary in the setting of Medicare. In the Commercial and Medicaid setting, 2B recommendations will be considered medically necessary if identified as such in an alternative compendium or supported by peer-reviewed scientific literature eligible for coverage (meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration); **OR**